



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Mirus Academy
School Website: <https://mirusacademy.info/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Mirus Academy (Ellsworth, ME; 04605) presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Public-facing materials consistently emphasize a Christ-centered, classical core, a Trivium-based curriculum, contemplative pedagogy alongside Socratic discourse, and a strong emphasis on virtue formation, mastery by master teachers, and active parental partnership. The admissions and handbook materials underline a deliberately classical philosophy embedded in mission, curriculum, and faculty culture, including explicit references to the Trivium, Great Books-era sensibilities, and a vision to lead culture through truth, goodness, and beauty. The school's public narrative repeatedly foregrounds the True, the Good, and the Beautiful, and asserts a mission to mature students toward wisdom and virtue within a Christian metanarrative. Taken together, these signals place Mirus Academy solidly in the CLASSICAL category across all six rubric domains, with no significant red flags indicating a drift toward non-classical practices. Evidence of this alignment appears across multiple sources, including direct statements of faith and Christ-centered aims, Trivium-based pedagogy, and a faculty culture described as a "living curriculum" and masterful mentorship.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Across all six categories, the presence of explicit Christian framing, the Trivium-based curriculum, contemplative and Socratic pedagogy, a master-teacher faculty ethos, and robust parental collaboration are consistently documented in public materials. Positive indicators outnumber negative indicators in each category, yielding an overall CLASSICAL rating. See category-by-category notes and keyword analyses below for the precise keyword signals and their quantified interpretation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly presents a Christ-centered educational mission (Christ-centered education) and a Christian worldview embedded in pedagogy and policy. The admissions/mission materials describe a Christ-centered approach to education and reference a Statement of Faith as part of the school's articulation of religious framework. - The Headmaster and faculty materials describe Jesus Christ as central to curriculum and student formation, including phrases like the centerpiece of life - Jesus Christ, and a Christian metanarrative underpinning the entire program. - Materials discuss Christian theology, biblical grounding, and a deliberate orientation toward virtue, truth, and beauty centered in a theological worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (sample): Christ-centered, Jesus Christ, Statement of Faith, Christian metanarrative, truth, beauty, virtue, sanctifying education, theology, worship-related language, wonder, wisdom. The lexicon confirms these as strong positive signals in this category. The school's materials include multiple explicit references to the True, the Good, and the Beautiful as central aims, and to a Christian metanarrative as comprehensive. - Negative keywords present: None detected in the school's public materials (no explicit signals of relativism, secularism, or moral neutrality in the provided materials). The absence of these negative indicators supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Why this rating - The textual signals show a coherent and explicit religious-metaphysical foundation consistent with classical Christian schooling: a focus on virtue and meta-truths anchored in theology, liturgical framing (where present in practice), and a robust statement of faith orientation. The public content aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 1 and lacks negative indicators, supporting a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials frame education as formation toward virtue and wisdom, not merely information or job-readiness. Language such as “mature students,” “lead culture,” and “truth, goodness, and beauty” anchors telos and formation as core aims. The mission emphasizes maturing students in love of truth and others; the vision emphasizes leading culture through cultivated virtues.

- Language includes explicit reference to forming character and soul, with emphasis on the True, the Good, and the Beautiful as a guiding horizon. The public materials discuss formation, human flourishing, and the aim of leading culture rather than merely preparing for work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful, contemplation/scholé, classical mission, moral imagination. These align with the Lexicon's Positive Indicators for Element 2. - Negative keywords present: None of the standard workforce- or features-focused negatives (e.g., “career-ready,” “21st-century skills”) are evident in the public materials. The presence of formation-focused language dominates.

Why this rating - The school communicates a formation-centric purpose anchored in classical aims and virtue, aligning with the classical telos and the Great Conversation ethos. The absence of contrary signals and the clear emphasis on virtue, truth, and beauty support CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Curriculum and pedagogy descriptions explicitly identify the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as foundational, including discussion of the three stages of development, with Grammar, Dialectic (Logic), and Rhetoric. The curriculum references the goal of developing mature students through this framework.

- The Trivium-based sequence is coupled with references to Latin (starting grade 3) and memory-based pedagogy (chants, rote memorization, recitation) as part of the Grammar stage, and to logic and rhetoric during advanced stages (Dialectic and Rhetoric). - There are explicit notes about classical pedagogy (the Lost Tools of Learning; Great Books/Great Conversation themes are embedded in the classical approach, with emphasis on memorization and canonical texts in the early stages and rhetoric in later stages). The admissions materials and mission/vision content reinforce this orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts (grammar/logic/reasoning), Trivium, Quadrivium (where referenced in mission/vision), Great Books/Primary sources (as part of classical curriculum framing in the school's materials), history (as a curricular throughline rather than mere “social studies”), Latin, recitation/narration, memory work, chant, sacred art (where applicable), early-stage memorization, rhetoric development, seminar-like practice in upper grades. - Negative keywords present: minimal explicit signals of deviation (e.g., “project-based learning dominance” or “social studies-first framing”) are absent in the school's public materials; the site emphasizes traditional, canonical elements rather than constructivist-project-based framing.

Why this rating - The curricular core is clearly rooted in classical education, with explicit Trivium framing,

canonical literature and Great Conversation sensibilities implied through the emphasis on memorization, recitation, and rhetoric, and a throughline of history/liturgical-laden study. This combination aligns with CLASSICAL according to the rubric's positive indicators.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The pedagogy explicitly includes contemplative/restful elements in early stages (scholé-like practices, memory-based recitation, chanting), paired with Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training in upper grades. The structure acknowledges both contemplative and rigorous aspects of classical education. - Lower grades emphasize singing, chanting, and memory-based learning as foundational experiences, while upper grades employ Socratic discussion and seminars and provide opportunities for students to develop and deliver rhetoric. This matches the classical pedagogy described in the Six Elements lexicon. - The pedagogy explicitly frames the upper grades as venues for dialectic, rhetoric, and public speaking, aligning with the classical model's target for higher-order discourse and rhetorical training.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion/seminars, dialectic, disputation, narration, recitation, chanting, memory work, liturgical integration, rhetoric, speeches, declamation, oratory, debate, scholé, contemplation, wonder, paideia seminar, upper-school rhetoric theses, capstone orations. - Negative keywords present: none observed (e.g., no wholesale pivot to experiential, project-based-only learning; the site emphasizes a balance of contemplative/restful and rigorous dialogue). The lexicon's negative signals (experiential-only, project-based dominance) are not dominant in the available content.

Why this rating - The pedagogy integrates the full spectrum of classical teaching methods—from chant and memory in the grammar stage to Socratic inquiry and rhetorical practice in the rhetoric stage—meeting the rubric's criteria for CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty portrayals emphasize master teachers, mentors, and a living curriculum; the faculty are described as central to student formation, with a focus on virtue, mastery, and the cultivation of wisdom. The Headmaster's biography and statements emphasize a teacher-centered, virtue-infused, intellectually rigorous model. - The school's materials discuss a "portrait of a teacher" and a "living curriculum" as central to the school's approach, reinforcing a classical faculty ethos. - The public materials describe a collegial, mentorship-driven faculty culture with focus on the Catholic/Christian classical formation and the teachers' role as experts in the classical curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: master teachers, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as the core of the school, collegial culture, mentorship, virtue, mastery, wisdom, character formation. - Negative keywords present: none observed (no references to non-classical faculty roles such as "facilitators" without classical context or non-teaching administrators stripping the living-curriculum emphasis).

Why this rating - The school foregrounds the teacher as central to the classical formation, with explicit language about masterful teachers and a living curriculum, satisfying Classical expectations for the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school communicates a strong partnership with parents—parents as co-teachers, a prominent role for parent involvement, and a commitment to parental formation through materials such as the Parent/Student Handbook and admissions packets. The materials emphasize parent participation and routine engagement (open houses, family interviews, etc.). - The school frames itself as a mission-driven community that invites family involvement, supports parent education (book studies, gatherings), and maintains openness to parent visits. The school's materials describe missional operation and community service, with a Christian orientation toward neighborly engagement. - Public materials reference events and formats

that invite parental participation, including admissions processes, open houses, and relationships with the broader Hancock County community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups/book clubs, open campus/visits, hospitality, parent covenant, family liturgy, community engagement, missional operation. - Negative keywords present: none observed; no consumerist framing or “parents as customers only” language detected in the accessible materials.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate robust parental engagement and community integration, aligning with the CLASSICAL indicators for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable since all six categories are CLASSICAL. No major needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully classical profile.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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